

Word family: **habit / habits / habitual / habitually / habituate / habituated / habituation**

Base word: habit

Plural: habits

Related forms: habitual, habitually, habituate, habituated, habituation

Useful expressions / extensions: form a habit, develop a habit, break a habit, get into the habit of, get out of the habit of, force of habit, creature of habit

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / adjective, adverb, and verb family (相關形容詞、副詞及動詞)

Your sentence:

> “That **habit** says a lot about her personality.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **habit** means **a behaviour that a person regularly repeats, often so consistently that it becomes characteristic of them**.

The sentence refers to your grandmother's repeated behaviour of:

> making tea and cutting fruit whenever you visit.

Because she does this regularly, the behaviour has become a recognizable **habit**, and the speaker feels that this repeated action reveals something about her caring personality.

繁體中文： ** **一個人經常重複、已形成固定模式的行為或做法；在這裡指她每次有人探望時都習慣為大家準備茶和水果**

中文翻譯：

> “That habit says a lot about her personality.”

「那個**習慣**其實很能反映她的性格。」

Here:

habit = 一個人經常重複、逐漸形成固定模式的行為

1. **habit = regularly repeated behaviour (個人習慣) — 習慣；慣常行為**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “That **habit** says a lot about her personality.”

「那個**習慣**其實很能反映她的性格。」

Practice 2

> “Reading before bed is one of her daily **habits**.”

「睡前閱讀是她其中一個日常**習慣**。」

Practice 3

> “He has a **habit** of checking his phone as soon as he wakes up.”

「他有一個一起床就查看手機的**習慣**。」

habit = 經常重複並逐漸固定下來的個人行為模式

2. **habit of + -ing / noun** (有.....的習慣) — 習慣做.....

A very common grammatical construction.

Practice 4

> “She has a **habit of making** tea for visitors.”

「她有為訪客**泡茶**的**習慣**。」

Practice 5

> “He has a **habit of speaking** very quickly.”

「他有**說話很快**的**習慣**。」

have a habit of doing something = 經常重複做某件事，以致形成固定習慣

This construction can describe:

* good habits

* bad habits

* neutral routines

3. **good habit (良好習慣) — 好習慣**

Practice 6

> “Drinking enough water is a good **habit**.”

「喝足夠的水是一個**好習慣**。」

Practice 7

> “She developed the **habit** of preparing everything the night before.”

「她養成了前一晚先準備好所有東西的**良好習慣**。」

****good habit = 對健康、學習、工作或生活有正面幫助的固定行為****

4. **bad habit (壞習慣) — 不良習慣；惡習**

Practice 8

> “Biting your nails can become a bad **habit**.”

「咬指甲可能會變成一個**壞習慣**。」

Practice 9

> “He is trying to stop the **habit** of staying up too late.”

「他正在嘗試戒掉熬夜太晚的**壞習慣**。」

****bad habit = 經常重複而對健康、工作、關係或生活造成負面影響的行為****

5. **form / develop a habit — 養成習慣**

Practice 10

> “She gradually **developed the habit** of walking every morning.”

「她逐漸**養成了每天早上散步的習慣**。」

Practice 11

> “It takes time to **form a new habit**.”

「**養成一個新習慣**需要時間。」

form/develop a habit = 透過持續重複某個行為，使它逐漸變成固定做法

6. **break a habit** — 戒掉 / 改掉習慣

Practice 12

> “It can be difficult to **break an old habit**.”

「要**改掉一個舊習慣**可能很困難。」

Practice 13

> “She is trying to **break the habit** of checking her phone during meals.”

「她正在嘗試**改掉吃飯時看手機的習慣**。」

break a habit = 停止一個已經形成並經常重複的行為模式

Especially common with undesirable habits.

7. **get into the habit of + -ing** — 養成做.....的習慣

Practice 14

> “Try to **get into the habit of** reviewing your notes every day.”

「嘗試**養成每天溫習筆記的習慣**。」

Practice 15

> “She got into the **habit of calling** her grandmother every week.”

「她**養成了**每星期打電話給外婆的習慣。」

get into the habit of doing something = 開始經常做某事，直到它變成固定習慣

8. **get out of the habit of + -ing — 不再保持某習慣；改掉習慣**

Practice 16

> “I got out of the **habit of reading** during the holidays.”

「假期期間，我漸漸**沒有保持閱讀的習慣**。」

Practice 17

> “He is trying to get out of the **habit of eating** late at night.”

「他正在嘗試**改掉深夜進食的習慣**。」

get out of the habit of doing something = 不再維持某個原本已形成的習慣

This can describe losing either:

* a good habit

* a bad habit

depending on context.

9. **by habit — 出於習慣；習慣性地**

Practice 18

> “She checked the door twice, almost **by habit**.”

「她幾乎是**出於習慣**地檢查了兩次門。」

Practice 19

> “He reached for his phone **by habit**.”

「他**習慣性地**伸手去拿手機。」

by habit = 因為某個行為已經形成習慣，所以幾乎自動地做出來

10. **force of habit — 習慣使然；出於慣性**

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 20

> “I still wake up at six even on weekends—just **force of habit**.”

「即使週末我仍然六點起床，只是**習慣使然**。」

Practice 21

> “She started preparing tea automatically, purely from **force of habit**.”

「她自然而然開始準備茶，完全是**出於習慣**。」

force of habit = 因為某個行為已重複很多次，以致幾乎不用思考便自然做出來

This is particularly relevant to your grandmother's repeated behaviour.

11. **creature of habit** — 習慣固定的人；喜歡按固定方式生活的人

A common idiomatic expression.

Practice 22

> “My grandfather is a **creature of habit** and eats breakfast at the same time every day.”

「我祖父是一個**生活習慣很固定的人**，每天都在同一時間吃早餐。」

Practice 23

> “She is a **creature of habit** who dislikes sudden changes.”

「她是一個**很依賴固定習慣、不喜歡突然改變的人**。」

creature of habit = 喜歡依照固定習慣和規律生活、較少改變做法的人

12. **habit** = customary behaviour of a group/society (群體慣例) — 習俗；慣常做法

The word can extend beyond one individual.

Practice 24

> “Eating late in the evening is a common **habit** in some communities.”

「在某些社群中，晚上較晚吃飯是一種常見的**生活習慣 / 慣常做法**。」

Practice 25

> “Social **habits** change over time.”

「社會的**生活習慣 / 慣常行為方式**會隨時間改變。」

habit = 某個群體長期反覆採取的慣常行為方式

This overlaps with **custom**, but **habit** emphasizes repeated behaviour more strongly.

13. **habit** = characteristic tendency (慣性 / 傾向) — 習慣性傾向

Sometimes **habit** describes a recurring behavioural tendency rather than one specific routine.

Practice 26

> “He has a **habit** of avoiding difficult conversations.”

「他有**習慣性逃避困難對話的傾向**。」

Practice 27

> “She has an unfortunate **habit** of interrupting people.”

「她有一個不太好的**習慣性傾向**，就是經常打斷別人。」

habit = 某種反覆出現、已成為個人行為特徵的傾向

This is still closely related to the main behavioural sense rather than a completely separate lexical concept.

14. **habit** = religious clothing (修道服) — 修道服

A genuinely separate lexical meaning.

Practice 28

> “The nun wore a traditional religious **habit**.”

「那位修女穿著傳統的**修道服**。」

Practice 29

> “The monks were dressed in simple brown **habits**.”

「修士們穿著簡單的棕色**修道服**。」

****habit = 某些修士、修女或宗教團體成員所穿的傳統服裝****

This is completely different from:

> habit = repeated behaviour.

It is less common in everyday conversation but remains established modern English.

15. ****habit = physical growth form of a plant/mineral (專業) — 生長形態；外形****

A specialized scientific meaning.

Practice 30

> “The plant has a spreading growth ****habit****.”

「這種植物具有向外擴展的****生長形態****。」

Practice 31

> “The crystal ****habit**** helps scientists identify the mineral.”

「晶體的****外形 / 晶體習性****有助科學家辨認礦物。」

****habit = 植物、晶體或其他自然物質典型的生長形式或外形****

This is a technical botanical/mineralogical sense and should remain secondary for ordinary learners.

16. ****habitual = done regularly or repeatedly (習慣性的) — 習慣性的；慣常的****

The main related adjective.

Practice 32

> “Her **habitual** kindness made visitors feel welcome.”

「她**一貫** / 習慣性的善意行為**令訪客感到受歡迎**。」

Practice 33

> “He arrived at his **habitual** time.”

「他在自己**慣常**的時間**到達**。」

habitual = 經常或反覆發生，以致成為某人的固定行為 / 正常模式

17. **habitual** = repeatedly doing something problematic (慣常 / 成習性的)

Often used for repeated undesirable behaviour.

Practice 34

> “He is a **habitual** latecomer.”

「他是個**經常遲到**的人。」

Practice 35

> “Habitual lack of sleep can affect concentration.”

「**長期習慣性睡眠不足**會影響專注力。」

habitual = 某種行為持續反覆發生，而不是偶爾一次

This adjective often sounds more formal than everyday **usual**.

18. **habitually** = regularly / as a habit (慣常地) — 習慣性地；經常地

Practice 36

> “She **habitually** arrives early.”

「她**慣常**都會提早到達。」

Practice 37

> “He **habitually** checks every detail twice.”

「他**習慣性地**把每個細節檢查兩次。」

habitually = 因為已成習慣而反覆、經常地做某件事

19. **habituate** someone/something to + condition (使習慣於) — 使適應；使習慣

A more formal/scientific related verb.

Practice 38

> “The animals were gradually **habituated** to human presence.”

「那些動物逐漸被**訓練 / 適應到習慣人類的存在**。」

Practice 39

> “Repeated exposure can **habituate** people to the noise.”

「反覆接觸可以令人逐漸**習慣那種噪音**。」

habituate = 透過反覆接觸，使人或動物逐漸對某種刺激、環境或情況習慣

This is more formal than ordinary:

> get used to.

20. **habituated to** = accustomed to something (已習慣於) — 已適應；已習慣

Practice 40

> “She had become **habituated** to the busy environment.”

「她已經**習慣了繁忙的環境**。」

Practice 41

> “The birds became **habituated** to the sound of traffic.”

「那些鳥逐漸**習慣了交通聲**。」

****be habituated to something = 經過反覆接觸後，已不再對某個情況或刺激產生強烈反應****

21. ****habituation = reduced response through repeated exposure (習慣化) — 習慣化；適應****

An important psychology/science term.

Practice 42

> “The reduced reaction is an example of ****habituation****.”

「反應逐漸減弱是****習慣化****的一個例子。」

Practice 43

> “Through ****habituation****, the animal stopped reacting to the harmless sound.”

「經過****習慣化****後，動物不再對無害的聲音作出反應。」

****habituation = 因同一刺激反覆出現，而令反應逐漸減弱的學習 / 適應過程****

This is especially common in:

- * psychology
- * neuroscience
- * animal behaviour

Important distinction: ****habit vs routine****

These overlap strongly but are not identical.

****habit****

often happens automatically because it has been repeated many times.

> “I check my phone out of habit.”

****routine****

is an organized or regular sequence of activities.

> “My morning routine includes breakfast and exercise.”

So:

****habit = repeated behavioural tendency****

****routine = regular pattern/schedule of activities****

A routine can contain several habits.

Important distinction: **habit vs custom**

**habit**

usually refers to repeated behaviour of an individual or group.

**custom**

usually refers to a socially or culturally established traditional practice.

> “Drinking tea every morning is my habit.”

「每天早上喝茶是我的習慣。」

> “Giving gifts at this festival is a local custom.”

「在這個節日送禮是當地習俗。」

So ****custom**** has a stronger cultural/social tradition component.

Important distinction: **habit vs behaviour**

**behaviour**

is extremely broad:

> anything someone does or the way they act.

**habit**

specifically means behaviour that is:

- * repeated
- * regular
- * established over time

So:

> every habit is behaviour,

but:

> not every behaviour is a habit.

A one-time action is behaviour, but not normally a habit.

Important distinction: **habit vs tendency**

habit

usually involves an established repeated pattern.

tendency

means a likelihood or inclination to behave in a particular way.

> “She has a tendency to worry.”

can mean she often does it,

but:

> “She has a habit of checking the door three times.”

suggests a much more recognizable repeated behaviour.

Important distinction: **habit vs addiction**

This distinction is important.

habit

= regularly repeated behaviour.

It can be:

- * easy or difficult to stop
- * positive, negative, or neutral

addiction

involves a much stronger pattern of compulsive use or behaviour and can involve dependence and significant harm.

Therefore:

> **bad habit**

should not automatically be equated with:

> **addiction**

The latter is much more specific and serious.

Important distinction: **habit vs practice**

habit

usually develops through repeated behaviour and can be partly automatic.

practice

can mean a customary way of doing something or deliberate repeated training.

For example:

> “Checking my phone before bed is a habit.”

> “Daily piano practice improves technique.”

The two can overlap when **practice** means an established custom, but their typical meanings differ.

Important distinction: **habitual vs usual**

usual

= what normally happens.

> “She arrived at her usual time.”

habitual

= repeatedly characteristic of someone's behaviour.

> “His habitual lateness annoyed everyone.”

Habitual often places stronger emphasis on an ingrained repeated pattern and can sometimes sound critical.

Important distinction: **habitual vs addictive**

habitual

means:

> repeatedly done as a habit.

**addictive

means:

> capable of causing or connected with addiction.

Something may be habitual without being addictive.

Important distinction: **habit vs habituation**

**habit

= the repeated behaviour itself.

> “Checking my phone is a habit.”

**habituation

= a psychological learning process in which repeated exposure causes a reduced response.

> “I stopped noticing the background noise because of habituation.”

So **habituation** is not simply a formal word for “habit.”

Important distinction: **habit vs religious habit**

This is the clearest lexical polysemy contrast.

**habit — behaviour**

> “She has a habit of making tea.”

= 她有泡茶的習慣。

**habit — clothing**

> “The nun wore a habit.”

= 修女穿著修道服。

Same spelling, completely different modern meanings.

Important distinction: **habit vs force of habit**

**habit**

= the established behaviour.

**force of habit**

= the reason a person performs it almost automatically because it has been repeated so often.

> “She reached for the teapot by force of habit.”

= 她因為習慣使然，自然而然伸手去拿茶壺。

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **habit** family:

* **habit — repeated behaviour** = 習慣 / 固定行為
 * **habit of doing something** = 有做某事的習慣
 * **good habit** = 良好習慣
 * **bad habit** = 不良習慣
 * **form/develop a habit** = 養成習慣
 * **break a habit** = 改掉 / 戒掉習慣
 * **get into the habit of** = 養成做.....的習慣
 * **get out of the habit of** = 不再保持 / 改掉某習慣
 * **by habit** = 出於習慣
 * **force of habit** = 習慣使然
 * **creature of habit** = 生活習慣非常固定的人
 * **habit — group behaviour** = 群體的慣常做法
 * **habit — religious clothing** = 修道服
 * **habit — scientific growth form** = 生長形態 / 晶體外形
 * **habitual** = 習慣性的 / 慣常的
 * **habitually** = 習慣性地
 * **habituate** = 使逐漸習慣 / 適應
 * **habituated to** = 已習慣於.....
 * **habituation** = 因反覆刺激而反應減弱的習慣化過程

As demonstrated in the curation reference, practical family extensions and grammatical constructions are included because they add genuine learning value, while they are still distinguished from separate lexical meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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habit — repeated behaviour	經常重複並逐漸固定下來的個人行為模式
habit of doing something	經常反覆做某件事，以致形成固定習慣
good habit	對健康、學習、工作或生活有正面幫助的固定行為
bad habit	經常重複並對生活、健康或他人造成不良影響的行為
form/develop a habit	透過持續重複某行為，使它逐漸成為固定做法
break a habit	停止一個已經形成並經常重複的行為模式
get into the habit of	開始經常做某事，直到形成固定習慣
get out of the habit of	不再維持原本已形成的固定習慣
by habit	因某行為已經成為習慣而自然 / 自動地做出來
force of habit	因反覆做某事太多次，以致幾乎不用思考便自動做出
creature of habit	喜歡依照固定規律生活、不喜歡經常改變做法的人
habit — group/customary behaviour	某個群體長期反覆採取的慣常行為方式
habit — characteristic tendency	已成為某人行為特徵的反覆傾向
habit — religious clothing	修士、修女等宗教人士所穿的傳統服裝
habit — scientific growth form	植物、晶體等自然物體典型的生長方式或外形

habitual	經常反覆發生，以致成為某人的固定行為 / 模式	
habitually	因為已成習慣而經常、反覆地	
habituate	透過反覆接觸，使人或動物逐漸習慣某種刺激 / 環境	
habituated to	經反覆接觸後，已適應並習慣某種情況	
habituation	因同一刺激反覆出現，導致反應逐漸減弱的適應過程	

For your original sentence

> “That ****habit**** says a lot about her personality.”

The exact meaning is:

****habit = 一個人經常重複、逐漸形成固定模式的行為****

More specifically, the ****habit**** is:

> whenever the speaker visits, the grandmother insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone.

Therefore:

> ****That habit says a lot about her personality.****

= ****「她這個一有人來探望便習慣照顧大家、準備茶和水果的固定做法，很能反映她的性格。」****

The sentence is not merely saying:

> she does this often.

It presents the behaviour as a ****recognizable recurring pattern characteristic of who she is****.

That is why ****habit**** connects naturally to the next sentence about her personality: her repeated behaviour reveals that she expresses affection through small acts of care.